

## Rainbow's End

..A NOVEL..

BY REX BEACH

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"The Iron Trail," "The Spoilers,"  
"Heart of the Sunset," etc.

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### CHAPTER XVII.

Rosa.

"Look!" Jacket clutched at O'Reilly and pointed a shaking finger. "More beggars! Christ! And those little children!" The boy tried to laugh, but his voice cracked nervously. "Are they children, or ghouls with legs under them?"

O'Reilly looked, then turned his eyes away. He and Jacket had reached the heart of Matanzas and were facing the public square, the Plaza de la Libertad it was called. Matanzas appeared poor and squalid, depressingly wretched; its streets were foul and the Plaza de la Libertad—grim mockery of a name—was crowded with a throng such as it had never held in O'Reilly's time, a throng of people who were, without exception, gaunt, listless, ragged. There was no afternoon parade of finery, no laughter, no noise; the benches were full, but their occupants were silent, too sick or too weak to move. Nor were there any romping children. There were, to be sure, vast numbers of undersized figures in the square, but one needed to look twice to realize that they were not pygmies or wizened little old folks. It was not strange that Jacket had compared them to ghouls with legs, for all were naked, and most of them had bodies swollen into the likeness of pods or calabashes. They looked peculiarly grotesque with their spidery legs and thin faces.

O'Reilly passed a damp hand across his eyes. "Just Heaven!" he breathed. "She—she's one of these!"

The reconcentrados overran Matanzas in an unclean swarm; streets and plazas were congested with them, for no attempt was made to confine them to their quarters. Morning brought them streaming down from the suburban slopes where they lived, evening sent them winding back; their days were spent in an aimless search for food. They snatched at crumbs and scavenged the gutters for crusts. How they managed to exist, whence came the food that kept life in their miserable bodies, was a mystery, even to the citizens of the city; no organized effort had been made to cure for them and there was insufficient surplus food for half their number. Yet somehow they lived and lingered on.

At the time of O'Reilly's arrival the sight presented by these innocent victims of war was appalling; it roused in him a dull red rage at the power which had wrought this crime and at the men who permitted it to continue. Spain was a Christian nation, he reflected; she had set up more crosses than any other, and yet beneath them she had butchered more people than all the nations of the earth combined. This monstrous, coldly calculating effort to destroy the entire Cuban people seemed to him the blackest infamy of all, and he wondered if it would be allowed to succeed.

Fortunately for the two friends, General Betancourt's generosity served to relieve them from any immediate danger of starvation. After making a few purchases and eating with the utmost

frugality, it seemed. "Of what use would your few pesos be among so many?" he inquired. "God has willed this, and he knows what he is doing. Besides, your 'pretty one' is probably as hungry as these people. No doubt we shall find that she, too, is starving."

O'Reilly slowly withdrew his hand from his pocket. "Yes! It's Rosa's money. But—come; I can't endure this."

He led the way back to the Plaza of Liberty and there on an iron bench they waited for the full day. They were very tired, but further sleep was impossible, for the death wagons rumbled by on their way to collect the bodies of those who had died during the night.

Neither the man nor the boy ever wholly lost the nightmare memory of the next few days, for their search took them into every part of the reconcentrado districts. What they beheld aghast them. Day after day, from dawn till dark, they wandered, peering into huts, staring into faces, asking questions until they were faint from fatigue and sick from disappointment.

As time passed and they failed to find Rosa Varona a terrible apprehension began to weigh O'Reilly down; his face grew old and drawn, his shoulders sagged, his limbs began to drag. It was all that Jacket could do to keep him going. The boy, now that there was actual need of him, proved a perfect jewel; his optimism never failed, his faith never faltered, and O'Reilly began to feel a dumb gratitude at having the youngster by his side.

Jacket, too, became thin and gray about the lips. But he complained not at all and he laughed a great deal. To him the morrow was always another day of brilliant promise toward which he looked with never-failing eagerness; and not for a single moment did he question the ultimate success of their endeavor. Such an example did much for the older man. Together they practiced the strictest, hardest economy, living on a few cents a day, while they methodically searched the city from limit to limit.

At first O'Reilly concerned himself more than a little with the problem of escape, but as time wore on he thought less and less about that. Nor did he have occasion to waste further concern regarding his disguise. That it was perfect he proved when several of his former acquaintances passed him by and when, upon one occasion, he came face to face with old Don Mario de Castano. Don Mario had changed; he was older, his flesh had softened, and it hung loosely upon his form. He appeared worried, harassed, and O'Reilly recalled rumors that the war had ruined him. The man's air of dejection seemed to bear out the story.

They had been enemies, nevertheless O'Reilly felt a sudden impulse to make himself known to the Spaniard and to appeal directly for news of Rosa's fate. But Don Mario, he remembered in time, had a reputation for vindictiveness, so he smothered the desire. One other encounter O'Reilly had reason to remember.

It so chanced that one day he and Jacket found themselves in the miserable rabble which assembled at the railroad station to implore alms from the incoming passengers of the Habana train. Few people were traveling these days, and they were, for the most part, Spanish officers to whom the sight of starving country people was no novelty. Now and then, however, there did arrive visitors from whom the spectacle of so much wretchedness wrung a contribution, hence there was always an expectant throng at the depot. On this occasion O'Reilly was surprised to hear the piteous whines for charity in the name of God turn suddenly into a subdued but vicious mutter of rage. Hisses were intermingled with vituperations, then the crowd fell strangely silent, parting to allow the passage of a great, thick-set man in the uniform of a colonel of volunteers. The fellow was unusually swarthy and he wore a black scowl upon his face, while a long puckering scar the full length of one cheek lifted his mouth into a crooked sneer and left exposed a glimpse of wolfish teeth.

O'Reilly was at a loss to fathom this sudden alteration of attitude, the whistle of indrawn breaths and the whispered curses, until he heard some one mutter the name, "Cobo." Then indeed he started and stiffened in his tracks. He fixed a fascinated stare upon the fellow.

Colonel Cobo seemed no little pleased by the reception he created. With his chest arched and his black eyes gleaming malevolently he swagged through the press, clicking his heels noisily upon the stone flags. When he had gone Jacket voiced a vicious oath.

"So that is the butcher of babies!" exclaimed the boy. "Well, now, I should enjoy cutting his heart out."

O'Reilly's emotions were not entirely unlike those of his small companion. His lips became dry and white as he tried to speak.

"What a brute! That face—ugh!"

He found himself shaking weakly, and discovered that a new and wholly unaccountable feeling of discouragement had settled upon him. He tried manfully to shake it off, but somehow failed, for the sight of Rosa's arch-enemy and the man's overbearing personality had affected him queerly. Cobo's air of confidence and authority seemed to emphasize O'Reilly's impotence and bring it forcibly home to him. To think of his lustful persecution of Rosa Varona, moreover, terrified him. The next day he resumed his hut-to-hut search, but with a listlessness that came from a firm conviction that once again he was too late.

That afternoon found the two friends among the miserable hovels which encircled the foot of La Cumbre, about the only quarter they had not explored. Below lay San Severino, the execution place; above was the site of the old Varona home. More than once on his way about the city O'Reilly had lifted his eyes in the direction of the latter, feeling a great hunger to revisit the scene of his last farewell to Rosa, but through fear of the melancholy effect it would have upon him he had thus far resisted the impulse. Today, however, he could no longer fight the morbid desire and so, in spite of Jacket's protest at the useless expenditure of effort, he set out to climb the hill. Of course the boy would not let him go alone.

The La Cumbre road seemed very long and very steep. How different the last time O'Reilly had swung up it! The climb had never before tired him as it did now, and he reasoned that hunger must have weakened him even more than he realized. Jacket felt the exertion, too; he was short of breath and he rested frequently. O'Reilly saw that the boy's bare, brown legs had grown bony since he had last noticed them, and he felt a sudden pang at having brought the little fellow into such a plight as this.

"Well, hombre," he said when they paused to rest. "I'm afraid we came too late. I'm afraid we're licked."

Jacket nodded listlessly; his optimism, too, was gone. "They must all be dead or we would have found them before this," said he. When O'Reilly made no answer he continued, "It is time we thought of getting away from here, eh?"

Johanne was sitting with his face in his hands. Without lifting his head he inquired: "How are we going to get away? It is easy enough to get into Matanzas, but—" He shrugged helplessly.

Jacket brightened at the thought of escape. "Hoi! I'll bet we can find a hole somewhere," said he. "We're not like these others. They haven't the spirit to try." There was a moment of silence, and then: "Caramba! You remember those jutas we ate? They were strong, but I would enjoy the smell of one now. Eh? Another week of this and we shall be living on garbage like the rest of these poor people."

Leaving Jacket to take his time, Johanne completed the climb alone, meditating upon the boy's words. "The spirit to try!" Where had his spirit gone, he wondered. Perhaps it had been crushed beneath the weight of misery he had beheld; surely he had seen enough. Hourly contact with sickness and misfortune on such a gigantic scale was enough to chill anyone's hopes, and although his sensibilities had been dulled, his apprehensions had been quickened hour by hour. Now that he looked the matter squarely in the face, it seemed absurd to believe that a tender girl like Rosa Varona could long have withstood the hardships of this hideous place; stronger people than she had succumbed, by the hundreds. Even now the hospitals were full, the sick lay untended in their hovels. No one, so far as O'Reilly knew, had undertaken to estimate how fast they were dying or the number of dead which had already ridden out of Matanzas in those rumbling wagons, but there were many. What chance was there that Rosa had not been among the latter?

As he breasted the summit of La Cumbre, O'Reilly beheld at some distance a bent figure of want. It was a negro woman, grubbing in the earth with a sharpened stick. After a suspicious scrutiny of him she resumed her digging.

(Continued in next issue.)

## LAPSED POLICIES OF WAR INNSURANCE MAY BE CONVERTED

Portland, Aug. 19.—Conversion of war risk insurance policies similar to those issued by commercial companies, in accordance with the revised plan of the government, affecting the enormous mass of the government insurance written by Uncle Sam when his sons went overseas, was thoroughly explained Monday at the Portland recruiting offices by Major G. V. Triplett, adjutant general's office, Washington, D. C., before a meeting of officers from all recruiting offices in the district.

A salient feature of the new proposal, and one which the Major bespoke the widest publicity, is that policies which have been allowed to lapse, as many have been since the return of the troops, may be reinstated with little difficulty.

## OREGON ELKS GATHER AT KLAMATH FALLS FOR CONVENTION MEET

KLAMATH FALLS, Aug. 14.—Close to 2000 Elks and their families are quartered all over town eager and anxious for the opening of the annual state convention of the Elks, which opens Thursday morning and lasts through till midnight on Saturday.

Klamath Falls never has taken on a more gala appearance. Wherever you go your eye meets the ever-present "Hello, Bill!" signs, the purple and white bunting, and the familiar Elk head and clock insignia of the order. "Bill" will walk under a great stucco arch bearing the inscription "Welcome B. P. O. E." Local Elks and townspeople will make every effort to give "Bill" such a welcome that he will never forget the hours he spent here.

## FALL MODELS SHOW SHORT SKIRTS CHIC FOR AUTUMN WEAR

Chicago, Aug. 19.—Dame Fashion may have taken a definite stand against conservation of cloth in bathing suits for women, but not so in the fall dresses and skirts. A bevy of Chicago buyers arrived in the Loop recently and brought with them the models that will be seen everywhere this fall. They are just like the "high ones" being worn in Paris—if not just a bit higher. Maybe the leaves will blush a little redder, but the hose handler is smiling.

Color blindness is much less com-

## SELFISHNESS PRIME NOTE IN DEMANDS OF RAILROAD WORKERS

WASHINGTON, Aug. 18.—The Republican Publicity association, through its president, Hon. Jonathan Bourne, today gave out the following statement from its Washington headquarters:

"In their appeal to the public for support of their measure reorganizing the railroads the four brotherhoods assume a most benevolent attitude. Full of sympathy for the abuses they claim capital has forced upon the poor people they invite support for their legislation, claiming 'that it is to benefit the consuming public, of which labor at present is the audible part.' But an examination of the bill itself shows that the brotherhoods have taken care first of themselves. Under its terms the Government will buy the roads from the present owners, issuing bonds to payment therefor. They will then be operated by the newly created 'National Railways Operating Corporation.' After providing for the payment of operating expenses, maintenance, renewals and sinking fund, the measure designates what remains as 'net earnings.' One-half of the net earnings are to be paid into the Treasury, in other words will be given to the people. The other half will be paid to the employees themselves, in the form of dividends in the proportion which each individual's compensation bears to the total compensation."

"In plain English that means that the railroad employees will take the money of all the people out of the Treasury and buy the roads. After that is done they propose to give 100,000,000 people half of the profits of operation. 5,000,000 people will keep the other half, assuming that there are 1,000,000 employees and that each represents a family of five. In other words each member of the brotherhoods will receive in profits 20 times more than any other citizen, and in addition will get his share as a member of the total population."

"After confiscating the roads without a cent of expenditure on their part, except as they form about five per cent of all who contribute taxes to the Treasury, these economic highwaymen propose to give each of their membership 20 times as large a share of the profits as any other person will be permitted to receive. That is what the so-called Plumb plan, reduced to its lowest terms, means, and a veiled threat is held over the country that unless their demands are complied with by Congress the railroad employees will effect a complete tie-up of our transportation systems, with its attendant paralysis of the nation."

"Bolshevism in Russia has nothing on this."

## PACIFIC FLEET NOT TO BE COMPARED WITH FAMOUS ONE OF 1908

SAN FRANCISCO.—The Atlantic fleet on its famous cruise around the world in 1908 was 141 days 7 hours en route from Hampton Roads, Va., to San Francisco. The new Pacific fleet's sailing time from Hampton Roads to a California port is 27 days. This is one of the interesting comparisons of the two fleets which have been made here.

The Atlantic fleet went around Cape Horn. The Pacific fleet comes through the Panama canal, not completed when the Atlantic fleet made its cruise.

The actual sailing time for the Atlantic fleet was 61 days 19 hours. The Pacific fleet is expected to make the trip in about 18 or 19 days actual sailing time.

In 1908 the American navy had no airplanes or submarines. It had few destroyers and less submarines.

The Atlantic fleet comprised 16 battleships with a flotilla of torpedo boats. The new Pacific fleet approximates 196 vessels of all classes.

When Admiral Evans led his fleet in parade here in May, 1909, his flagship led but 42 vessels of all descriptions.

## PACKER IS ARRESTED WHILE BOASTING OF REDUCTION OF COST

Louisville, Ky., Aug. 18.—Howell Thomas, resident manager for Armour & Co., one of the "big five" packing concerns, addressed the state food commission here on "What the packers are doing to reduce the high cost of living." As he stepped from the platform at the finish of the talk a deputy United States marshal buttonholed him. The Deputy had a Federal warrant charging food wastage to serve on Thomas.

## NEW RADIO STATION IN FRANCE WILL HAVE 12,500 MILE RADIUS

PARIS, Aug. 17.—The new wireless station to be erected at Croix d'Hins, near Bordeaux, will have a sending radius of 12,500 miles, according to the Excelsior.

It will be one of the most powerful wireless stations in the world, the paper adds, and will have a capacity of

## Signs of the Times

When we read that the shoe dealers have in store for us \$20 shoes, the clothing men intimating that \$100 will be about the amount required for a presentable suit, the bakers asking for a modest raise in the price of the daily loaf, the milkman taking an occasional uplift in his prices, we are reminded that it's up to the investigating committee who are to tell us why prices are so high, to do some effective work, and do it before the temper of the people is thoroughly exhausted. It has been a consistent race between wages and prices, as to who could keep ahead in the race. Neither side has been contented to call the race a draw and get down to the actual work of reconstruction. It's nearly time for a new league of producer and consumer.

## MINE MULES VISIT TOPSIDE AFTER MANY YEARS UNDERGROUND

GRASS VALLEY, Or., Aug. 16.—For many years, some of which recently had their first glimpse of daylight in 10 or 15 years, are being returned to the underground workings in the Empire and North Star mines here after a brief sojourn in the open. The mules "visit" to daylight resulted from the miners' strike here recently. The mines were stopped and as the water began to fill the workings it was necessary to bring the mules to the surface. They had been used in hauling ore cars on the different levels.

Many of the mules through the influence of their keepers had cultivated a taste for chewing tobacco, and some were said to have made known their desire for their daily "chew" by being untractable while on the surface if it was denied them.

## BRITISH NAVAL FORCE DEFEATS RUSSIANS IN SMALL ENGAGEMENT

LONDON, Aug. 19.—A Russian battleship, a cruiser, a transport and a guardship were sunk by British naval forces in a sea engagement with the Bolsheviks in the Gulf of Finland on Sunday, said a news agency dispatch from Helsingfors today.

The British lost only three motor-boats.

## NEW YORK CAR STRIKE ENDS IN COMPROMISE AFTER TWO-DAY TIE-UP

NEW YORK, Aug. 19.—The strike which for two days paralyzed the subway and elevated system of the Interborough Rapid Transit company in Manhattan, the Bronx, Brooklyn and Queens, was formally called off tonight by a vote of the strikers to accept a compromise offered them at a conference of city and state officials this afternoon.

The number of Girl Scouts in the United States now totals over 60,000.

## COURT DECLARES MAN DEAD THAT ESTATE MAY BE ADJUSTED

Albany, Aug. 18.—For the second time this summer the county court has declared a man dead when absolute proof of death was lacking. Harry Scully, owner of a half interest in a Linn county farm, left the county 20 years ago and was heard from a couple of years later. His only relative was his brother, joint owner with him of the farm. The brother died last February, leaving a son and daughter, who sought an order declaring their uncle dead and adjudging them to the ownership of the property, valued at \$1200.

## STATE LIME BOARD ISSUES STATEMENT REGARDING PRODUCT

PORTLAND, Aug. 18.—In response to inquiries in regard to the state lime board and its products the following statement has been prepared by Secretary A. B. Cordley.

The board produces ground lime, stone pulverized so that all of it will pass through a screen of 10 meshes to the inch. This means that half of it will pass through a screen of 40 meshes to the inch. This is the best possible form in which to apply lime to the land.

In order to obtain reduced freight rates the lime is shipped only in bulk in carload lots. The price of the lime is \$2.50 per ton f. o. b. car at Gold Hill, Or.

## WORLD'S CHAMPION JERSEY IS 'MOTHER TO LIBERTY BULL

PORTLAND, Aug. 18.—The famous champion Jersey cow, "Vive La France," owned by Pickard Brothers of Marion, Or., which recently made 1031 pounds of butterfat in one year, the Jersey world's record over all ages, has dropped a fine bull calf that was carried 175 days during the period of her remarkable record.

## KLAMATH FALLS HAS OVRCOME HANDICAP AND RAISES CATTLE

KLAMATH FALLS, Aug. 18.—Completely healed of the grievous wound left by promoters who took their profits and decamped in the boom days, Klamath Falls has become the capital of a cattle empire of the modern variety, where grazing has largely given way to feeding of rich alfalfa grown under irrigation on the valley floor that is now verdant with lush crops.

The United States government, although slow to move, has since 1906, when it took over and amalgamated a number of private irrigation projects, been helping the ranchers of Klamath build this empire.

The work of reclamation of lands formerly covered by Lower Klamath lake is now practically finished. Meetings are now being held to decide the cultivation of what was once the lake bottom. Tule lake is receding fast, and in a short time the land that was its bottom will be thrown open to tillers of the soil.

With these two projects accomplished, with high line ditches completed, with the formerly reservoir completed and its water turned through canals onto the land, with high line ditches getting water from the inexhaustible Upper Klamath lake, Clear lake and Horseshoe reservoir, this empire will total 200,000 acres of easily tilled, naturally adapted, wonderfully productive alfalfa land, from which two cuttings of two or more tons per acre each will be taken each year.

In this estimate the United States government figures are essentially correct, for they are the result of a series of surveys upon which work now going forward has been based.

At the present time crops are being harvested on 33,127 acres under ditch and considerable acreage farmed as dry lands which will be under ditch soon.

## BRITISH FIELD PIECE OF LATEST MODEL IS ADDED TO EQUIPMENT

Oregon Agricultural College, Corvallis, Aug. 18.—Another section of the artillery unit authorized by the war department reached the college when a modified British 75, together with caissons and limber, was received. This gun has been bored for the use of American and French ammunition and has been added to the four piece three-inch battery already at the campus.

## FOES OF DAY SAVING WILL TRY TO DEFEAT PRESIDENTIAL VETO

WASHINGTON, Aug. 18.—Advocates of the repeal of the daylight saving law will make a determined effort to pass the measure over the president's veto. His message vetoing the bill reached the house Friday, but adjournment was taken following a point of quorum before there was opportunity to read it.



"I Can't Stand That," He Confessed. frugally, they began their search. Later they stretched themselves out to sleep on the stones beneath the portales of the railroad station.

They spent a horrid, harrowing night, for now the general distress was brought home to them more poignantly than ever. At dawn they learned that these people were actually dying of neglect. The faint light betrayed the presence of new corpses lying upon the station flagstones. From those still living, groans, sighs, sick mutterings rose until O'Reilly finally dragged his youthful companion out of the place.

"I can't stand that," he confessed. "I can't sleep when people are starving to death alongside of me. This money burns my pocket, I—I—"

Jacket read his purpose and laid a detaining hand upon his arm.

"It will save our lives, too," he said simply.

"Bah! We are men. There are



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